

Run Guide — Flask Quiz App

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This document explains how to run this Flask quiz project on a Windows machine (PowerShell). It also shows how to generate a PDF of this guide.

Prerequisites - Python 3.8+ installed and on PATH - PowerShell (Windows PowerShell v5.1 is fine)

Quick steps (copy/paste in PowerShell)

1) Open PowerShell and go to the project folder

```
```powershell cd 'C:\path\to\flask-quiz-app-main\flask-quiz-app-main' ```
```

2) Create & activate a virtual environment

```
```powershell python -m venv venv # Activate .\venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1 ```
```

If activation is blocked, run once in this PowerShell session:

```
```powershell Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process -ExecutionPolicy Bypass .\venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1 ```
```

3) Install dependencies

```
```powershell python -m pip install --upgrade pip pip install -r requirements.txt ```
```

4) Create the database and default admin

```
```powershell python create_db.py ```
```

This script creates the `quiz.db` SQLite file, default categories, and an admin user: - username: `admin` - password: `admin123`

5) Run the app locally

```
```powershell python main.py ```
```

Open the app in a browser: <http://127.0.0.1:5000>

Optional: run on LAN (access from other devices)

A) Quick dev command (bind to all interfaces):

```
```powershell # using flask CLI $env:FLASK_APP = 'main.py' $env:FLASK_ENV = 'development' flask run --host=0.0.0.0 --port=5000 ```
```

B) Or edit `main.py` and set host to '0.0.0.0'

Firewall: allow incoming connections for port 5000 if you want other machines to connect.

Generate a PDF of this guide (two options)

Option A — Use Pandoc (if available):

1. Install pandoc (<https://pandoc.org/installing.html>) 2. Run:

```
```powershell pandoc README_RUN.md -o run_guide.pdf ```
```

Option B — Use the provided Python script (requires `reportlab`):

1. Install reportlab inside venv:

```
```powershell pip install reportlab ```
```

2. Run the generator script:

```
```powershell python generate_run_guide_pdf.py ```
```

After running, `run\_guide.pdf` will be created in the project root.

Troubleshooting - "python" not found: install Python and add to PATH. - Activation blocked: use `Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process -ExecutionPolicy Bypass`. - Port 5000 blocked: choose a different port or allow it in Windows Firewall. - DB errors: confirm `quiz.db` file created and `create\_db.py` ran without errors.

Extras you might like me to add - `run.ps1` script to activate venv and run the app in one command - `run\_guide.pdf` pre-built in the repo - Dockerfile for containerized runs

If you want, I can now add the `generate\_run\_guide\_pdf.py` script so you can create the PDF locally. Which option do you prefer (I will add the Python PDF generator now if you say yes)?